

FAHAD QURESHI

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PROFILE

Technology executive with 18+ years leading enterprise technology strategy, governance, and modernization across regulated financial institutions — including BMO Capital Markets, Royal Bank of Canada, and Manulife. Proven track record managing budgets up to \$22MM, leading teams of 60+, and delivering measurable outcomes: \$30M+ in cost savings, 50%+ productivity gains, and 2× release velocity. Deep expertise in cybersecurity, compliance, cloud infrastructure, and AI-enabled modernization, with a strong focus on aligning technology investment with member and business value.

COMPETENCIES

Leadership: Technology strategy & governance · P&L ownership (budgets to \$22MM) · Team management (60+) · Vendor management & cost optimization · Regulatory compliance

AI & Architecture: Azure AI Foundry · Logic Apps agent workflows · Power BI AI integration · LLMs & LangChain · Claude Code (AI-first development) · Multi-cloud (Azure, AWS, GCP) · Node.js, React, Java · Cosmos DB, SQL Server

AI Governance: Built enterprise AI governance platform incorporating ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, and EU AI Act · Policy operationalization for regulated industries · AI risk management frameworks · Responsible AI adoption

Delivery: Agile at scale (SAFe, Scrum@Scale) · OKR frameworks · Portfolio governance & PMO · Digital modernization · Offshore team scaling · CI/CD & DevOps

Domain: Banking & capital markets (BMO, RBC) · Insurance enterprise (Manulife) · CapEx/OpEx optimization · Regulatory readiness · AI/LLM governance

EXPERIENCE

CTO & Chief Product Owner — Protago

07/2022 – Present | Montreal

- Built and launched an AI/LLM governance platform from \$0 to \$200K+ ARR, operationalizing regulatory compliance frameworks for enterprise clients
- Implemented Azure AI Foundry and Logic Apps to build agentic workflows and pipelines; integrated with Power BI for AI-powered governance reporting and analytics
- Pioneered AI-first development using Claude Code across the entire engineering team — standardizing AI-assisted requirements, design, and coding, resulting in a step-change increase in team productivity
- Reduced Azure infrastructure costs by 50% through serverless architecture; established offshore development team reducing monthly spend by 50%

Enterprise Consultant — Manulife / John Hancock

06/2021 – 06/2025 | Boston / Toronto

- Realigned cross-functional fraud prevention program at John Hancock, delivering \$30M+ in annual savings and doubling throughput
- Designed CapEx/OpEx reclassification model using real-time attribution, reclassifying 17% of OpEx to CapEx and eliminating manual timesheets
- Achieved 28% ROI improvement and 3× OKR attainment; introduced delivery dashboards and agile practices that doubled release velocity
- Chaired governance and strategy sessions; led KPI-driven portfolio reviews across \$MM technology transformation portfolios

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Director & Head of Business Agility COE — Royal Bank of Canada

06/2018 – 06/2021 | Toronto

- Built and scaled the Business Agility Centre of Excellence from the ground up, establishing coaching programs, governance frameworks, and tooling adopted across the enterprise
- Led enterprise-wide agility transformation across 4 divisions, driving 50%+ productivity gains in four key business units and enabling faster response to regulatory and market changes
- Facilitated adoption of prioritization and work visualization practices among 20% of RBC executives within two years, improving strategic alignment and decision-making
- Aligned technology delivery to business outcomes via OKR-led operating committees; reduced delivery risk and improved transparency across major programs

FICC Architect & Agile Adoption — RBC Capital Markets

06/2017 – 06/2018 | Toronto

- Led the DevOps transformation for Fixed Income, Currencies & Commodities technology, integrating Jira, Jenkins, Ansible, ELK stack, and automated testing tools end-to-end
- Increased development efficiency by 35% and reduced downtime and manual effort across 20 applications by 25%, accelerating time-to-market
- Coached and mentored Fixed Income IT leadership on Agile practices, embedding a continuous improvement culture across the division

Director & Regional Head of FX Technology — RBC Capital Markets

10/2016 – 06/2017 | Toronto

- Joined RBC from BMO as Regional Head of FX Technology with full P&L ownership of a \$22MM budget; achieved \$5MM in vendor cost savings through strategic renegotiation
- Generated \$3MM in additional recurring revenue by increasing deal flow in EM FX forwards through targeted technology improvements
- Replaced aging legacy infrastructure with a modern, scalable stack; doubled quarterly release cadence through Agile adoption and OKR-driven delivery

Head of FX Technology — BMO Capital Markets

01/2014 – 02/2016 | Toronto

- Oversaw 60+ IT professionals and \$17MM annual budget across FX trading, operations, and sales technology
- Led the end-to-end replacement of IBUK, BMO's 1970s-era core FX operations system, delivering full CLS (Continuous Linked Settlement) membership and eliminating significant operational risk
- Implemented Wall Street Systems 5.0 as the modern FX trading platform, replacing multiple legacy systems and establishing a unified, scalable stack
- Built a custom CRM for the FX Sales team, improving client relationship management and deal tracking; eliminated paper-based workflows through digitization and automation
- Decreased FX operations costs, amplified recurring revenue, and automated risk management processes through disciplined technology and process transformation

Earlier Roles — BMO Capital Markets

01/2008 – 2014 | Toronto

- Software Development Manager (2012–2014): Managed FX development teams delivering key platform modernization programs including Wall Street Systems 5.0 and the IBUK replacement initiative
- Team Lead (2010–2012): Led FX trading and operations development team; established engineering practices and mentored junior developers in a Java-based capital markets environment
- Java Developer (2008–2010): Built deep domain expertise in FX trading workflows, settlement processes, and operations systems as an individual contributor on BMO's core FX platform

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EDUCATION

M.A.Sc., Electrical and Computer Engineering — University of Toronto (2003 – 2006)

B.A.Sc., Electrical and Computer Engineering — University of Toronto (1999 – 2003)

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified SAFe 4 Program Consultant — Scaled Agile | Certified Scrum@Scale Practitioner — Scrum Inc. |
Convolutional Neural Networks in TensorFlow — Coursera | Natural Language Processing in TensorFlow — Coursera